Border Tech Texts: Data Inventory Report

Folder: `/Users/yuxin/Dropbox/Border Tech Texts`
Prepared: 28 October 2026. Read-only inspection; no files in the folder were modified.

1. What the data is

A LexisNexis full-text corpus on border technology, exported in two batches (27 and 30 April 2026) and organized by country and year. Each row is one LexisNexis document (news article, transcript, government document, industry brief, or press release) with its full text and metadata.

Item	Value
Archives	10 zip files (7 from 27 Apr, 3 from 30 Apr 2026)
Size	7.08 GB compressed, 21.5 GB uncompressed
Files inside	5,217 CSV files, one identical 16-column schema
Country / region folders	168 (167 countries and territories + `south_africa_airports`)
Year coverage	1990 – 2025
Document rows (country × document)	65,618
Unique documents (by `ResultId`)	32,812
Total words of full text	1.15 billion
Words per document (10th pct / median / 90th pct)	392 / 6,194 / 40,783
Language	English only in practice (`Language` column is blank in every row)

Columns: `Country, ResultId, Title, Date, Language, Source, WordLength, Overview, Snippet, FullText, Byline, Section, Location, Jurisdiction, WebNewsUrl, MediaReadLink`. `FullText` ends with LexisNexis index metadata (subject, industry and geography codes, copyright line, retrieval timestamp), which should be stripped before text analysis.

2. File organisation

Pattern	Files	Meaning
`<country>_1990–2025.csv`	168	One combined file per country (all years). 163 countries have one; usa, south_africa, south_korea, central_african_republic and south_africa_airports have per-year files only.
`<country>/<country>_<year>_all.csv`	2,549	One file per country-year, all languages.
`<country>/<country>_<year>_english.csv`	2,500	Same query restricted to English. In 1,686 of 1,994 pairs the `_all` and `_english` files are byte-identical in size; the rest differ by a handful of rows.

The combined file is the concatenation of that country's per-year files, so the per-year and combined layouts hold the same documents. Per-year files exist only for years with hits (median 14 year-files per

country).

3. Countries

Coverage is extremely uneven. The ten largest folders hold 63% of all rows.

Documents per country	Countries
≥ 2,000	7
500 – 1,999	21
100 – 499	37
10 – 99	69
< 10	34

Rank	Country folder	Documents
1	usa	8,067
2	central_african_republic	6,656
3	south_korea	6,346
4	hong_kong	5,133
5	uk	3,916
6	south_africa	3,485
7	north_korea	3,334
8	israel	1,665
9	macao	1,456
10	malaysia	1,219
11	sri_lanka	1,099
12	canada	1,084
13	philippines	1,061
14	australia	1,031
15	costa_rica	780

The country folder reflects the search query, not necessarily the article's subject. LexisNexis geography tags show the United States in 56% of rows, China in 20%, the United Kingdom in 14%, so the corpus is US-centric regardless of folder.

Folders that look inflated by loose query matching and deserve a spot check: central_african_republic (6,656), vatican (571), micronesia (376), western_sahara (335), saint_vincent (264).

The full per-country table is in the appendix.

4. Years

Period	Unique documents	Country × document rows
1990–1994	147	349
1995–1999	568	1,449
2000–2004	2,892	5,490
2005–2009	6,770	11,683
2010–2014	4,882	9,899
2015–2019	7,245	16,268
2020–2025	10,308	20,480

Volume is thin before 2001, rises sharply after 2001 and again after 2016, and peaks in 2020 (2,013 unique documents, 4,170 rows). 2025 is a partial year (export date April 2026, but documents dated through December 2025 are present).

5. Topics

Topics below are LexisNexis subject index terms attached to each document, counted over the 65,618 country × document rows (a document carries many terms, so columns do not sum to 100%). The generic tag NEGATIVE NEWS is the most frequent (26,757 rows) and is not listed.

Border control, customs & immigration

Subject term	Rows	Share
Border Control	14,912	23%
Territorial & National Borders	12,382	19%
Immigration	8,408	13%
Excise & Customs	7,580	12%
Passports & Visas	4,864	7%
Smuggling	4,743	7%
Illegal Immigrants	3,853	6%
Refugees	2,062	3%

Security, terrorism & defense

Subject term	Rows	Share
National Security	16,722	25%
Terrorism & Counterterrorism	12,825	20%
Weapons & Arms	9,516	15%
Special Investigative Forces	9,440	14%
Terrorist Attacks	5,369	8%
Armies	5,084	8%
Defense & Military Policy	4,753	7%
Defense Industry	3,846	6%

Surveillance & border technology

Subject term	Rows	Share
Surveillance	6,664	10%
Biometrics	5,157	8%
Surveillance Technology	3,234	5%
Computer Software	2,486	4%
Unmanned Aircraft	2,242	3%
Defense Electronics	2,061	3%
Information Security & Privacy	1,784	3%
Military Surveillance	1,702	3%

Crime, policing & drugs

Subject term	Rows	Share
Crime, Law Enforcement & Corrections	10,473	16%
Controlled Substances Crime	3,591	5%
Arrests	3,502	5%
Drug Trafficking	2,837	4%
Narcotics	1,481	2%
Organized Crime	1,109	2%
Money Laundering	539	1%

Aviation, ports & travel

Subject term	Rows	Share
Aircraft	5,296	8%
Traveler Safety & Security	2,947	4%
Aviation Security	2,447	4%
Harbors & Ports	1,515	2%

Public health / COVID-19

Subject term	Rows	Share
COVID Coronavirus	4,381	7%
COVID-19 Coronavirus	4,284	7%
Infectious Disease	3,591	5%
Epidemics	2,064	3%
Pandemics	1,384	2%

Politics, government & legislation

Subject term	Rows	Share
Government Advisors & Ministers	8,508	13%
US Congress	6,880	10%
US Republican Party	4,980	8%
Prime Ministers	4,674	7%
US Democratic Party	4,424	7%
Public Policy	4,116	6%
Elections & Politics	3,525	5%
Legislation	3,053	5%

International relations & EU

Subject term	Rows	Share
International Relations	7,239	11%
Agreements	6,736	10%
European Union Member States	5,879	9%
European Union	5,259	8%
United Nations	3,802	6%
Foreign Relations	3,327	5%

Economy & trade

Subject term	Rows	Share
Economy & Economic Indicators	4,631	7%
Budgets	4,080	6%
Business News	3,506	5%
Manufacturing	3,340	5%
International Trade	2,448	4%

Reading: the corpus is framed around border control and national security. Technology-specific terms (surveillance, biometrics, drones, identification technologies, AI, RFID, radar, scanners) each appear in only 1 to 10% of rows, so most documents discuss borders, migration, terrorism or customs with technology as one strand rather than the main subject. A COVID-19 cluster (2020 – 2022) is substantial.

6. Sources and document types

1,456 distinct sources. Grouped by source name (approximate):

Source category	Rows	Share of rows	Unique documents
News media (newspapers, broadcasters, agencies, monitoring)	28,725	44%	16,679
US government transcripts & documents	17,425	27%	8,891
Industry / financial briefs & databases	13,699	21%	4,473
Press releases / newswires	2,960	5%	1,889
Blogs / aggregators	2,809	4%	880

Top sources	Rows
Industry SnapShot	5,975
Briefing.com	4,134
VIQ Political Wire	2,952
Federal News Service	2,865
CQ Congressional Testimony	2,328
Gates of Vienna	2,318
CQ Transcriptions	2,309
States News Service	1,796
CountryWatch Reviews	1,775
Congressional Documents and Publications (Federal Information & News Dispatch, Inc.)	1,456
Targeted News Service	1,312
Impact News Service	1,244

Notes: US congressional hearing testimony and transcripts (Federal News Service, CQ, States News Service, VIQ Political Wire) are a large block. Industry SnapShot, Briefing.com, CountryWatch and similar financial or country-risk briefs are templated reports rather than journalism and are the main reason some

documents run to tens of thousands of words. Gates of Vienna and Newstex are blog aggregators. The `Section` column is blank in 64% of rows.

7. Duplicates and redundancy

Kind of duplication	Count
Rows that repeat a document already present under another country	32,806 of 65,618 rows (50%)
Unique documents appearing in 2 or more country folders	14,542 of 32,812 (44%)
… in exactly 1 / 2 / 3 / 4 / 5+ folders	18,270 / 7,383 / 3,210 / 1,801 / 2,148
Most folders a single document appears in	41
Duplicate rows inside one country folder	501 (all in central_african_republic); none elsewhere
Rows with `WordLength` = 0 but text present	4,371
Rows with empty `FullText`	25
File paths present in both download batches	189 (France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Poland, Spain)

Structural redundancy. Every document is stored up to four times: in the combined file and the per-year file, each in an `_all` and an `_english` version. The unique content is therefore roughly a quarter of the 21.5 GB on disk.

Cross-batch consistency. For France, Italy, Poland, Spain and Germany the 30 April batch contains the same documents as the 27 April batch (identical or a subset, e.g. France 528 of 644, Italy 445 of 576); file sizes differ only because of the retrieval timestamp inside `FullText`. Greece is different: the 27 April per-year files hold 893 documents covering 1990 – 2013, the 30 April files hold 386 (combined file 602) covering 1995 – 2025, and only about 100 documents are shared. The Greece query was evidently changed between runs, and one version should be chosen deliberately.

8. Practical recommendations

- Work from one layout only (the combined files, or the per-year `_all` files) and ignore `_english`.
- De-duplicate on `ResultId` for corpus-level counts; keep the country assignment as a separate many-to-many table.
- Decide whether to keep financial briefs (Industry SnapShot, Briefing.com, CountryWatch) and blog aggregators; together they are about a quarter of rows.
- Strip the LexisNexis index block from the end of `FullText` before any text analysis.
- Resolve the two Greece versions, and spot-check the inflated small-country folders listed in section 3.

Appendix: documents per country folder (unique within folder)

Country	Docs	Country	Docs	Country	Docs	Country	Docs
usa	8,067	new_zealand	220	cambodia	41	slovenia	12
central_african_republic	6,656	egypt	220	bulgaria	40	guyana	11
south_korea	6,346	cape_verde	215	austria	40	haiti	11
hong_kong	5,133	colombia	200	spain	38	ethiopia	11
uk	3,916	guinea_bissau	192	iceland	37	belize	10
south_africa	3,485	ukraine	181	belarus	37	bahrain	10
north_korea	3,334	lebanon	171	niger	36	serbia	10
israel	1,665	equatorial_guinea	169	mozambique	36	luxembourg	10
macao	1,456	oman	148	morocco	34	mauritius	9
malaysia	1,219	finland	146	chile	33	north_macedonia	9
sri_lanka	1,099	libya	141	fiji	32	mauritania	9
canada	1,084	lithuania	138	romania	32	brunei	9
philippines	1,061	azerbaijan	131	seychelles	29	benin	8
australia	1,031	indonesia	131	jamaica	28	namibia	8
costa_rica	780	saint_lucia	129	denmark	27	eritrea	7
india	776	armenia	126	tunisia	27	zambia	6
afghanistan	719	cuba	125	myanmar	27	laos	6
palestine	658	poland	124	cameroon	25	mali	6
france	644	norway	114	peru	24	barbados	5
papua_new_guinea	629	portugal	113	chad	21	paraguay	5
taiwan	619	nicaragua	110	venezuela	21	marshall_islands	5
greece	602	kosovo	107	lesotho	20	honduras	4
italy	576	saint_kitts_nevis	105	qatar	19	bosnia	4
vatican	571	uganda	96	mongolia	19	dominica	4
south_sudan	545	hungary	89	algeria	18	suriname	3
singapore	539	estonia	88	tajikistan	17	slovakia	3
japan	514	panama	78	madagascar	16	ivory_coast	2
iraq	511	malta	77	georgia	16	eswatini	2
sierra_leone	484	djibouti	77	kazakhstan	16	el_salvador	2
south_africa_airports	478	turkey	70	argentina	16	czech_republic	2
china	467	nepal	68	samoa	16	senegal	2
congo_republic	465	dominican_republic	65	germany	16	vanuatu	2
netherlands	430	croatia	63	tanzania	15	uruguay	2
micronesia	376	drc	61	botswana	15	timor_leste	2
iran	344	kenya	61	sudan	15	andorra	1
western_sahara	335	liberia	61	bhutan	14	uzbekistan	1
ireland	283	ghana	60	kuwait	14	gambia	1
pakistan	276	maldives	57	ecuador	14	angola	1
bangladesh	264	jordan	55	thailand	14	albania	1
saint_vincent	264	sao_tome_principe	53	moldova	13	kyrgyzstan	1
somalia	255	rwanda	47	latvia	13	grenada	1
mexico	223	guatemala	44	cyprus	12	kiribati	1